

HOMESERVANT

App Overview

What HomeServant does, for each type of user

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Source: `docs/guides/app_overview.html` — rebuild with `python3 docs/guides/build.py`.

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1. What HomeServant is

HomeServant connects people looking for a home with landlords, and people who need home services with vendors, with payments held safely by the platform until each side has done their part. It runs in the browser (and as a mobile app) for four kinds of user:

Who	What they do
Tenants	Browse homes and shortlets, pay to rent or book, arrange inspections, move in, renew, and message landlords they've paid.
Landlords	List and manage properties, handle bookings and inspections, get paid, and message tenants.
Vendors	Run a marketplace shop once an admin approves them: products, orders, messages, payouts.
Admins	Run support and moderation from a separate web console, at three levels: Support, Moderator, Super Admin.

2. Accounts and signing in

- **Sign up** with email and password (a 4-digit code confirms the email) or with Google, then fill in a short profile. *Every profile field is required*: name, a valid Nigerian phone number, date of birth (18 or older), home address, profile photo, means of ID and its number, gender, occupation and marital status; landlords also upload a certificate of ownership and a document (a photo or PDF). Only the referral code is optional. ID details and documents are stored privately and reviewed by HomeServant moderators, who verify or reject them (with a reason). Verified people get a blue **Verified** check (listings from verified landlords show it on the photo and property page), and each person sees their own status on their profile. A super admin can switch on *Only verified landlords* (Platform Controls), which hides unverified landlords' listings from tenants and blocks new bookings on them. Tenants who already booked or saved one still see it, marked as hidden because the landlord is unverified, and their booking carries on. Unverified landlords are notified and can submit their documents from *Get verified* on their profile or dashboard. A second switch, *Pay unverified landlords* (on by default), decides whether unverified landlords are paid as normal or have their payouts held by HomeServant until they are verified; tenants are never affected either way. An unfinished signup can be picked up again with the same email.
- **Sign in** on the tenant/landlord page (or the marketplace for vendors). Optional extras in Settings: *Two-Factor Authentication* (an emailed code at every sign-in) and *App Lock* (a PIN whenever the app reopens).
- **Forgot password** sends a reset code by email.
- **Deactivate** hides the account; signing in again reactivates it. **Delete** removes it for good.
- **Each sign-in page only takes its own kind of account.** A landlord on the tenant sign-in page (or a tenant on the landlord page) is told which page to use, with a button to switch; the same goes for "Continue with Google". Vendors sign in on the tenant page (a shop belongs to a tenant account). **Admins** sign in only on the admin console's own page; the regular sign-in pages, and Google sign-in, refuse admin accounts.

3. Tenants

Finding a home

- The dashboard opens on **All** listings, each labelled with its category; tabs narrow it to House, Shortlet, Self-Con or Apartment. Search by name or area, and filter by price and location. The price boxes start empty (the category's price range shows as a hint), so tenants just type a minimum, a maximum or both.
- A property page shows photos, video, details, rating and reviews. Save favourites to the **Wishlist**.

Renting a home (House, Self-Con, Apartment)

1. **Rent Now** takes payment straight away: the Paystack checkout opens in the same tab and returns to HomeServant afterwards. The money is *held* by HomeServant, not paid to the landlord yet.
2. Book an inspection date (now or later from History). The landlord confirms or declines it; a declined date can be re-proposed.
3. After inspecting, the tenant confirms they've **moved in**, which releases the payment to the landlord and starts the lease.
4. Before moving in, the tenant can ask for a **refund**, or the landlord can reject the booking (a full refund).
5. Rent reminders arrive 30, 15 and 0 days before the lease ends; **Renew Lease** pays for the next period.

Eviction requests

- A landlord can ask to end a current tenancy early from the property's page (*Request eviction*), giving a written reason.
- The tenant is notified and emailed straight away, sees the reason on the booking in History, and can **respond** with their side.
- **Nothing changes** until a HomeServant *super admin* reviews the case and decides. The landlord can withdraw the request while it's under review.
- If approved, the lease ends that day and the property is listed again; the tenancy can't be renewed. If rejected, the tenancy carries on. Both sides are notified and emailed with the decision.

Booking a shortlet

The tenant requests dates; the owner accepts or declines; the tenant then pays, and the payment goes to the owner straight away.

Paperwork

History shows every booking and payment. **Tenancy Agreements** keeps each lease's agreement to view or download.

4. Landlords

- **Payout account first:** a landlord adds a bank account (checked against the bank) before listing.
- **Add a property** from the *Upload a Property* button on the dashboard home (or Profile), with photos, video, price, rooms, lease length (or unit details for a shortlet), and whether tenants may message them.
- **My Properties:** search, filter by status and category, sort (price, name, rent expiring), and see each listing's price, rooms, pending requests, tenant and rent expiry at a glance.
- **Bookings:** accept or decline shortlet requests, confirm inspection dates, reject a paid booking (refunding the tenant), view a tenant's profile, and see the rent roll.
- **Delete a listing** only when nobody lives there and no tenant's money is being held.
- **My Tenants** (dashboard home or Profile): everyone who has rented or paid for a stay, filtered by Current / Former / All and searchable by name, with when they rented and when their rent expires (highlighted within 30 days). Tapping a tenant shows their email, phone, occupation, marital status and every tenancy with that landlord, with *Evict tenant* on a current one. A tenant's phone number is only shown once they have paid for that landlord's property.
- **Request an eviction** from an occupied property's page, with a reason; a super admin must approve it (see Eviction requests above).

5. Money: escrow, refunds and payouts

- Payments go through Paystack. Rent is **held** until move-in, then paid out to the landlord's account, minus the platform fee.
- A tenant's own refund before move-in returns the money less a small fee; a landlord's rejection refunds in full.
- No one is ever paid or refunded twice, and a payment can't be both paid out and refunded. If a payout or refund doesn't go through (a bank or Paystack problem), the tenant's move-in or stay still goes ahead and a super admin sees it on the *Payouts & Refunds* screen to retry it, or to refund a tenant who hasn't moved in. After an admin refund, the tenant can't request another.
- Marketplace payments are held until the buyer confirms receipt (or released automatically after 7 days unless disputed).

6. Messaging

- **Tenants and landlords** can message each other once the tenant has **paid** for that property. Before that, a landlord may reach out and the tenant may reply.
- If a booking is **refunded** (by the tenant or a landlord rejection), the chat closes for both sides until the tenant pays again. A notice in the chat says why, and the old messages stay readable.
- Marketplace buyers and vendors message each other about an order.
- Messages show *Sending...*, *Seen*, or *Not sent · Tap to retry*. Photos can be sent.
- New messages arrive live; if one sits unread for 15 minutes, the recipient also gets an email.

7. Marketplace: customers and vendors

- **Customers** browse products, order and pay, track orders, and confirm receipt.
- **Vendors** apply with their business details and bank account. Once an admin approves them, their products appear in the marketplace; they manage products, orders and messages, and see their transactions.

8. Support

- **Contact Support** offers a phone number or a **live chat**. The user first picks what it's about (Payments, Booking, Account, Listing, Marketplace, Other).
- The chat goes straight to an admin who is on duty. If nobody is available, the user is told they're in the queue and will be notified when someone replies; the first admin to come on duty picks it up, and super admins are emailed if it waits 15 minutes.
- If the chat is transferred, a notice says who has it now.
- Either side can end the chat: the admin marks it resolved, or the user taps **End chat**. The user is then asked to rate it (1–5 stars) if an admin replied.

9. Notifications

- In-app: a bell with a count, and banners for new messages, bookings, payments and support updates. Opening a chat clears its notifications.
- Browser notifications: after tapping *Turn on*, notifications arrive even when HomeServant is closed. Signing out stops them on that browser.
- Email: sign-in codes, booking and payment updates, and unread messages.

10. The admin console

A separate web console at `/#/admin-login`, with three levels: Support, Moderator and Super Admin. It covers:

- users, vendors, properties and marketplace moderation;
- reports;
- support chats, with auto-assignment, transfers, internal notes, saved replies, customer details and handling history;
- the admin roster, with search and level filters;
- the activity log;
- **Support Insights** (response times, ratings and workload).

The Admin Guide explains each part and what each level may do.

11. Where to read more

Document	For
Admin Guide	Admins: using the console, levels and permissions, support chats, emergencies.
Frontend Developer Guide	Developers: how the Flutter app is organised and talks to the API.
Backend Developer Guide	Developers: the API's data, endpoints, background jobs, settings, tests and deployment.